Winning the GCC

GTM strategy for Ashapura Softech in KSA & UAE

Business Development Manager – GCC | Market insights & penetration plan

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Executive summary

1 Approaching GCC

Salesforce is investing heavily in KSA ($500M, Riyadh HQ, local Hyperforce). Demand is outpacing local partner capacity.

2 Where to play

GCC mid-market, 100–2,000 employees: real estate, automotive, BFSI, healthcare, retail & trading, logistics.

3 How to win

Local front + offshore engine. Multi-platform credibility at 30–50% below local specialists.

4 How to start

Salesforce co-sell first, then network, outbound engine, events. UAE quick wins, KSA as the revenue engine.

Why me: the right first hire for a new region

12 yrs	B2B Sales and Business Development, dealing everyday with C-Level Suite
5 yrs	Technology Business: Salesforce and Odoo / ERP
Dubai	Based in the UAE with Emirates ID, and driving License; ready to start
KSA	Active decision-maker network, and on-hands experience

Some of the Logos I have closed with Salesforce

Steel Manufacturing	Automotive	Real Estate

What I bring on day one

- Salesforce and Odoo selling experience: credible across the multi-platform offer
- Full-cycle hunter: prospecting to close, independently
- Cross-vertical exposure in all six priority verticals

The market opportunity

Why the GCC, why Salesforce, why now

Salesforce is betting on Saudi Arabia, and partners are the bottleneck

$500M

Salesforce investment in KSA announced at LEAP 2025, including partner-ecosystem expansion

Riyadh

New Salesforce regional HQ (Jan 2025) plus an AI Center of Excellence with IBM

Hyperforce

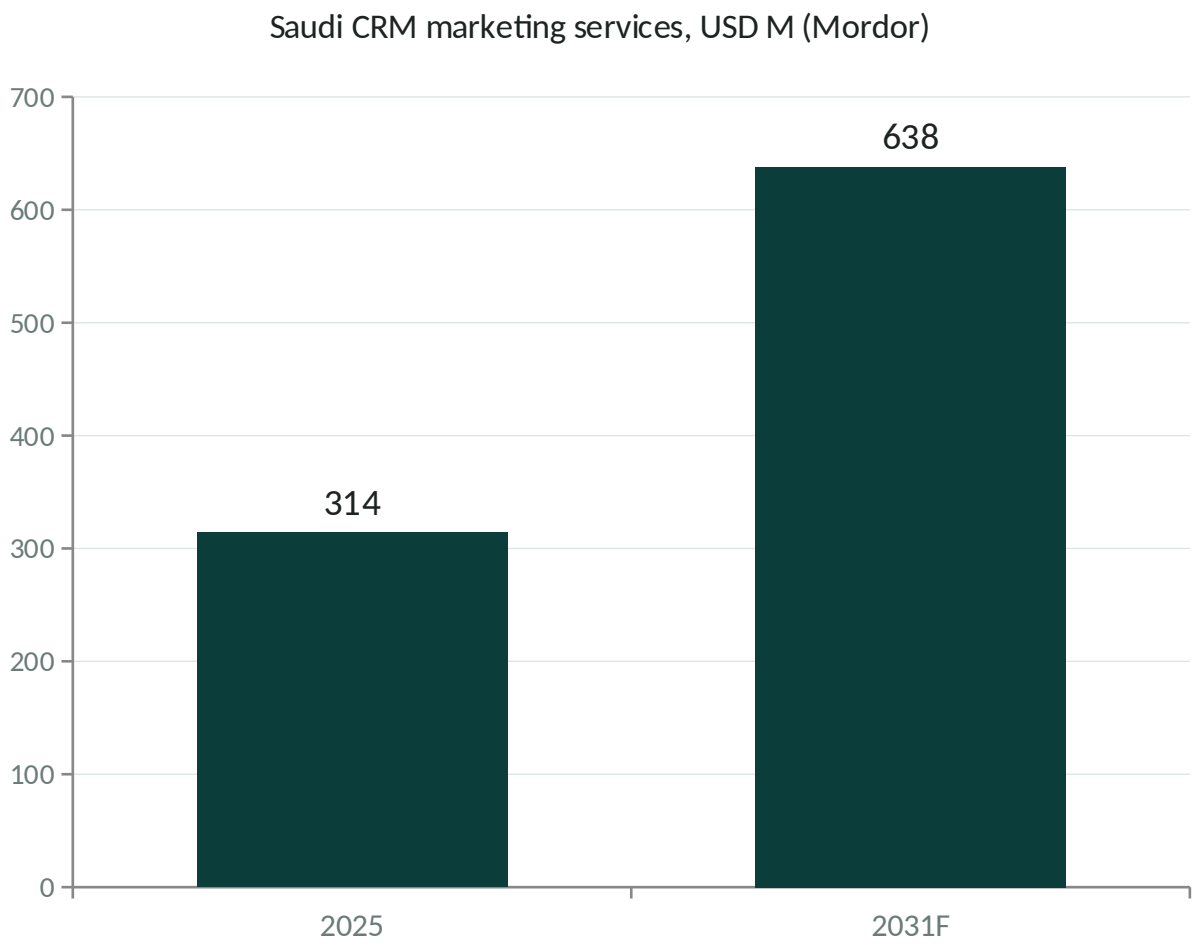
Local hosting on AWS in KSA unlocks BFSI, government and healthcare (SAMA/PDPL)

30k

Saudis to be upskilled by Salesforce by 2030, a signal of long-term demand

Implication: Salesforce needs more capable local partners. A new entrant with real delivery capacity is welcome, not blocked.

A double-digit growth market, led by KSA



~30% KSA share of the GCC CRM market, the largest country (IMARC)

12.9% Saudi CRM services CAGR to 2031

13.6% UAE CRM services CAGR to 2031

Second wave: existing Salesforce customers now need optimization, data cleanup and Agentforce readiness.

What GCC buyers need, and competitors under-deliver

1

Arabic / RTL

Bilingual portals for government, retail and healthcare

2

WhatsApp-first

The dominant customer channel in the region, and non-negotiable

3

Local integrations

ZATCA e-invoicing, Nafath, UAE Pass, SADAD, local portals

4

Compliance

PDPL, SAMA, data residency through Hyperforce

5

Rescue & optimize

Poorly implemented orgs, low adoption, unused licenses

6

Managed services

Local Salesforce talent shortage creates recurring support (AMS) demand

Priority verticals: start where we already have proof

Priority	Vertical	Why it matters in GCC	Lead Salesforce play
1	Real estate & developers	Off-plan sales boom in UAE and KSA; portal-driven leads (Bayut, Property Finder)	Sales Cloud + Experience Cloud broker portal
2	Automotive dealerships	Large family-owned dealer groups, service retention, multi-brand	Automotive Cloud / Service Cloud
3	BFSI & fintech	Unlocked by Hyperforce; digital banking and lending growth	Financial Services Cloud
4	Healthcare	Private hospital groups expanding in KSA	Health Cloud + patient engagement
5	Retail, eCommerce & trading	Large trading houses and distributors: B2B ordering, dealer networks, omnichannel	Commerce Cloud (B2B) + Sales Cloud
6	Logistics	Vision 2030 logistics-hub agenda	Service Cloud + field service

The competitive landscape

Who is already winning in KSA & UAE, and where they are exposed

Five competitor groups, and two that matter most

		Threat to Ashapura
Global SIs	Accenture, Deloitte, PwC, Capgemini, IBM, Globant, Publicis Sapient	Low in mid-market
Regional specialists	Smaartt, Cloudzlab, Arcsen, Cloud Concept, EI-Technologies, Cloudastick	High
Egypt/Levant delivery	Cloudzlab, Cloud Concept, zCloud: Arabic at near-offshore rates	Medium–High
Indian offshore peers	Netsmartz, Ksolves, Cynoteck, Codleo, Appsierra	High (same pitch)
Substitutes	Microsoft Dynamics, Zoho, HubSpot, Odoo partners	Neutralized

Regional Salesforce specialists: the main battlefield

Firm	Base	Positioning / claims	Exposed on
Smaartt	Dubai	Claims largest regional partner; Summit; UAE, KSA, Qatar, Oman; 150+ customers	Premium price, capacity
Cloudzlab	Dubai + Cairo	Since 2015; ME Partner of the Year FY20; Platinum/Summit	Salesforce-only, mid-size bench
Arcsen	Dubai	Founded 2021; Salesforce, MuleSoft, Tableau, Slack; retail, auto, airlines, public sector	Young, few long-term references
Cloud Concept	Dubai / Cairo	Partner since 2009; 300+ projects; UAE, Egypt, Qatar, KSA	Ageing positioning
EI-Technologies Arabia	Riyadh, AD, Dubai	In region since 2011; KSA presence	Smaller scale
Cloudastick Systems	KSA	Sales, Service, Marketing Cloud; 24/7 managed support	Thin public footprint
Sendan / Cetrix / Leadex	Riyadh / KSA / Dubai	ZATCA localization; Salesforce.org; MuleSoft integration niches	Niche, limited breadth

Global SIs above us, offshore look-alikes beside us

Global system integrators

Accenture · Deloitte · PwC · Capgemini · IBM · Globant · Publicis Sapient (Changi) · KPMG · EY

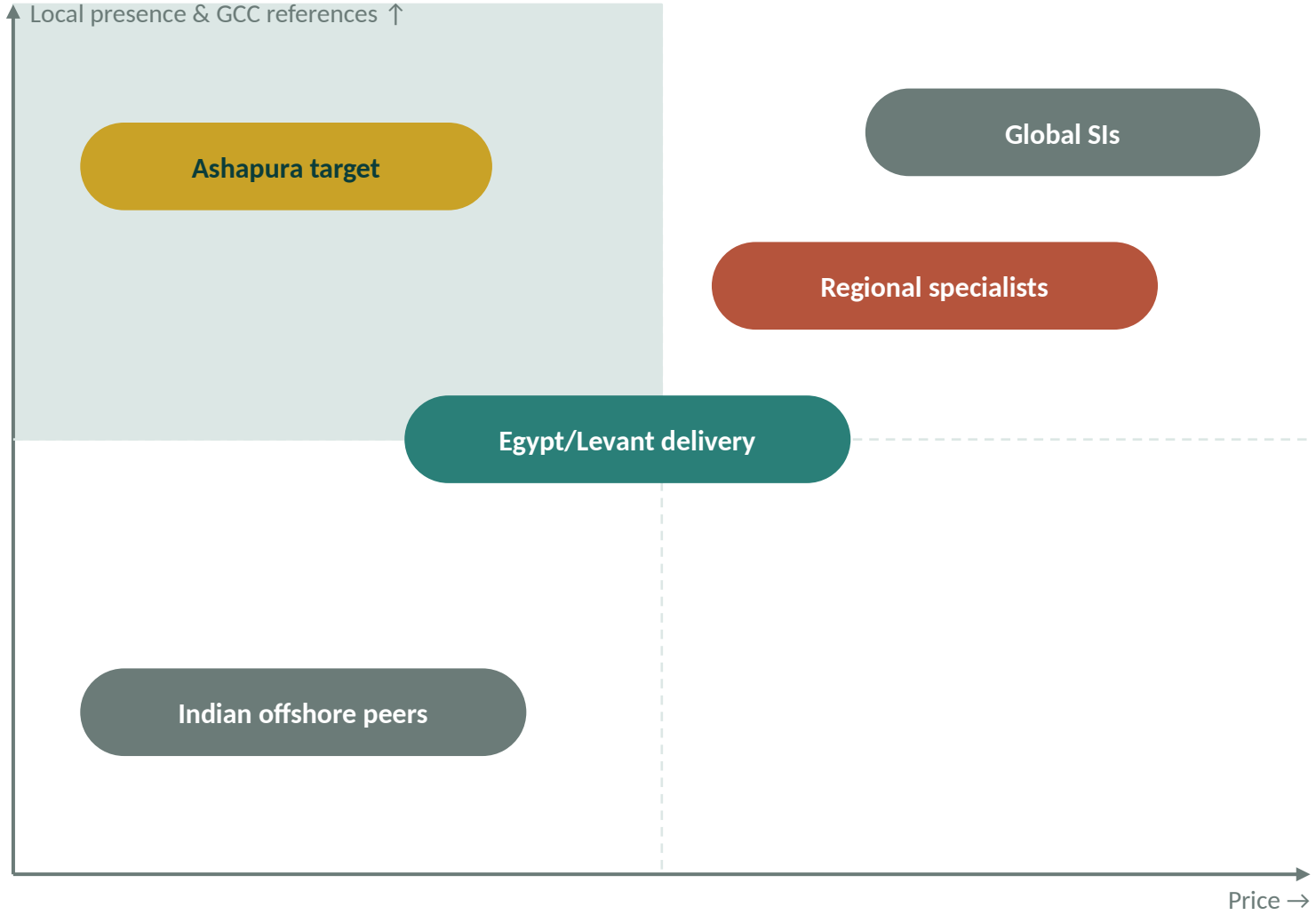
- Strong: brand, government and giga-project access, Salesforce co-sell
- Weak: expensive, slow, ignore deals under ~$300–500K
- Our play: own the mid-market and offer subcontract delivery capacity

Indian offshore peers

Netsmartz · Ksolves · Cynoteck · Codleo · Appsierra · Cloud Analogy

- Strong: lowest price, large bench
- Weak: SEO-led, remote, few GCC case studies, transactional
- Our play: real local presence, KSA network, vertical packages, on-site workshops

The open space: local presence at offshore price



Our position

- Local relationship owner in Dubai, covering KSA
- India delivery at 30–50% below local specialists
- Salesforce-led, with Zoho, Odoo and Microsoft when they fit better
- We never lose a deal to a platform

How we beat each competitor group

Competitor group	Their strength	Their weakness	How Ashapura wins
Global SIs	Brand, C-suite and government access	Cost, speed, junior delivery	Mid-market focus; subcontract delivery to them
Regional specialists	References, Arabic, Salesforce AE ties	Premium pricing, capacity, Salesforce-only	Fixed-price packages, 72h proposals, multi-platform
Egypt/Levant delivery	Arabic at low cost	Narrow platform scope	Hire 1–2 Arabic consultants in-region; broader stack
Indian offshore peers	Lowest price	No local presence or references	Local face, KSA network, on-site workshops
Substitutes	Lower license cost	Platform-locked advice	Platform-agnostic: right tool, Zoho → Salesforce path

Go-to-market plan

Positioning, ICP, channels and offers

Positioning: a local front with an offshore engine

"The Salesforce-led, multi-platform CRM partner for GCC growth companies: local ownership, Arabic-ready, delivered at offshore speed and cost."

1

Local

Dubai-based, KSA network, face-to-face selling (how Saudi decision-makers buy), Arabic capability

2

Multi-platform

Salesforce 70% · Zoho 20% · Odoo / Microsoft 10%. The right fit, every time

3

Value

Fixed-price packages, offshore cost, 6–8 week QuickStarts

Ideal customer profile and buying signals

Who

- GCC companies with 100–2,000 employees
- The six priority verticals
- UAE and KSA first, then Qatar

Segments

- On Salesforce, under-using it: rescue / AMS / AI
- On Zoho, Dynamics or legacy and scaling
- Greenfield: new entities, RHQs, giga-project suppliers

Personas

- CIO / CTO / CDO
- Head of Sales, Customer Experience or Marketing
- CFO (ZATCA, cost), owner / GM of family groups

Signals

- Hiring Salesforce admins or developers
- KSA expansion or RHQ licence, funding
- New CX leadership; Etimad tenders

Channel strategy, in order of leverage

1	**Salesforce co-sell**	Partner Account Managers and AEs in Dubai and Riyadh hand implementation work to trusted partners
2	**Personal network**	Warm intros in KSA and UAE: automotive, real estate, ERP / Odoo contacts
3	**Outbound engine**	Signal-based prospecting with Sales Navigator and Lusha, plus multi-touch sequences
4	**Events**	GITEX (Dubai, Oct), LEAP (Riyadh, Feb), Big 5 Saudi (real estate), Salesforce World Tour, Cityscape
5	**Alliances**	WhatsApp/CPaaS providers, ERP partners, ISVs, Global SIs for subcontracting
6	**Content**	Arabic + English LinkedIn content, GCC playbooks (ZATCA, WhatsApp, Agentforce)

Entry offers: packaged wedges to shorten the first sale

1

Org Health Check

2 weeks · free or low cost

Opens doors at existing Salesforce customers; leads to rescue and AMS

2

Vertical QuickStart

6–8 weeks · fixed price

Real estate CRM or dealer CRM on Sales and Service Cloud

3

Zoho → Salesforce

Migration package

For scale-ups outgrowing Zoho; our multi-platform edge

4

Agentforce Pilot

4-week proof of concept

One AI use case, built on clean data

5

Managed services

Monthly retainer

Recurring revenue that keeps the account

Outbound engine: a predictable pipeline from month one

400 targeted contacts / month

25–30 conversations (~8–10% reply)

8–10 discovery meetings

3–4 qualified opportunities

Engine components

- Stack: Sales Navigator, Lusha, sequencing tool, Salesforce as our own CRM
- 3-week cadence: LinkedIn → value email → call → WhatsApp
- Hooks: vertical insight, Health Check offer, local integrations

$0.4–1M outbound pipeline per quarter (5-7 opps at $40–150K), before co-sell and network deals for the first year.

Execution roadmap

UAE quick wins, KSA revenue engine

Roadmap: UAE base, KSA engine

1 **0–3 months**

Foundation

- Salesforce PAM / AE introductions in Dubai and Riyadh
- ICP, target list of 150 accounts, sequences live
- First Health Checks and network meetings

2 **3–6 months**

First wins

- 2–3 UAE mid-market deals closed
- First KSA opportunities through network
- Arabic consultant hired or partnered

3 **6–12 months**

Scale KSA

- KSA legal setup or local alliance
- Case studies published; event presence (LEAP)
- AMS base building recurring revenue

What success requires: resources, KPIs and risks

What I need

- Partner tier and certified headcount visibility
- 2–3 global case studies reworked for GCC
- Arabic pre-sales consultant within 6 months
- Event budget, GCC rate card, pricing authority
- Intro to Salesforce PAM & AEs (UAE / KSA)
- KSA legal setup plan

KPIs

- Qualified leads and meetings per month
- Pipeline value and conversion rate
- New logos and revenue vs. quarterly target
- Salesforce co-sell deals registered
- AMS recurring revenue

Risks → mitigation

- Long KSA cycles → mid-market and UAE mix
- No local references → pilots and subcontracting
- Offshore perception → local presence, hybrid delivery
- Saudization → local alliance partner

Ready for the GCC

Local front · Offshore engine · Salesforce-led, multi-platform (Zoho, Odoo, Microsoft)

Next step: align on the 30-60-90 day plan, targets and resources